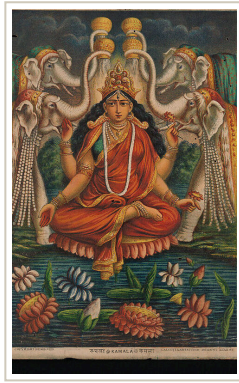


TANTRAYA

Supplementary Workbook · The Ten Mahavidyas

Kamala

She of the Lotus



Kamala, seated on the lotus, bathed by her elephants

Tenth and Final of the Mahavidyas · Completion

Kamalatmika, she who dwells in the lotus

Holding wealth, beauty, and pleasure differently

Tantraya · Sacred Valley of Peru

At a Glance

RANK	Tenth and final of the Mahavidyas
NAME MEANS	“She of the lotus,” also Kamalatmika, “she who dwells in the lotus”
FORM	Golden complexion, seated in lotus posture on a lotus, four arms, bathed by elephants pouring nectar
IDENTIFIED WITH	Sri-Lakshmi. Within the Mahavidya group, the tantric form of the same goddess
HER DOMAIN	Wealth, meaning one’s whole relationship to value, giving, and receiving, well beyond money itself
FOCUS OF THESE PRACTICES	Recognizing abundance already present, and practicing giving and receiving without contraction

The Myth

Her defining story is the churning of the ocean of milk, in which gods and demons work together to draw the nectar of immortality up from the depths of the cosmic ocean. Among what rises from that churning is Lakshmi herself, seated on a lotus, radiant and fully formed. Elephants stand at her sides pouring water and nectar over her, an image of pure abundance, given rather than earned or fought for, arriving as a natural consequence of the ocean being stirred rather than as a reward for any particular effort.

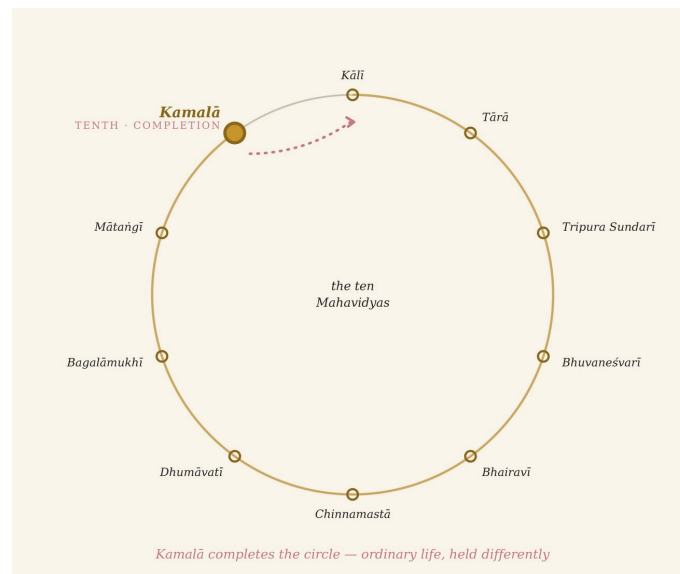
Symbolism and Image

The lotus carries two meanings that matter here. It is rooted in mud, yet its flower stays untouched by what it grows out of, an image of something remaining clean and whole while still fully embedded in ordinary, often difficult, conditions. This is worth sitting with, because it is different from rising above the world or leaving it behind. The lotus does not escape the mud. It grows directly out of it and stays connected to it, while the part that opens to the light carries none of it.

The elephants pouring nectar over her point at something else: real abundance moves toward her without being summoned or forced. She does not reach for the nectar. It is simply given. This is a very different image of wealth than most people carry, where getting more of anything requires effort, competition, or worry about scarcity.

Understanding the Energy

Kamala's placement as the tenth and final Mahavidya is not explained in the source texts, and there is genuine disagreement among those who study this material about what it means. One reading treats her placement as minor. She is the most widely worshipped of the ten outside the Mahavidya context, and some scholars have suggested her inclusion here is a later, looser fit compared to goddesses like Dhumavati or Bagalamukhi, who exist almost nowhere outside this particular group.



The ten Mahavidyas: Kamalā completes the circle

A more useful reading, for our purposes, treats her position as completion rather than afterthought. The nine Mahavidyas before her move through radical territory: death, fear, sacrifice, loss, the interruption of momentum, invisibility. Kamala is where the practitioner arrives after all of that, back in ordinary life, holding money, beauty, pleasure, and comfort again, but no longer holding them the way they did before. This is far from the starting point of the path, where someone believes wealth and beauty are the whole of what matters. It is closer to what it looks like to hold those same things afterward, once you have been through everything the other nine put you through. The lotus growing out of mud is the same image again: she is rooted in the material world, and something in how she holds it has changed.

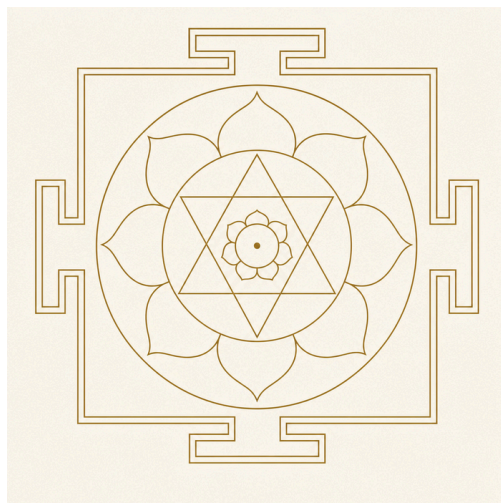
This changes what her domain, wealth, actually means. It was never really about money. It is about your relationship to value in general: whether you can recognize what you already have, whether you can give and receive without contracting, and whether what you call wealth is actually serving you or simply keeping old fears quiet. The practices below work directly with that.

How to Work With These Practices

These practices are not about acquiring more or feeling grateful for what you have, though gratitude may show up. It is about examining your actual relationship to wealth, scarcity, desire, and exchange, closely enough to see what is habit and what is real.

Work through the practices in order. Notice where you contract, where you deflect, and where old fear is running the show without your permission. The aim is not comfort. It is clear sight into how you hold value, so you can hold it differently.

Practices



The Kamala Yantra: eight lotus petals within the bhupura, holding the hexagram of union

Kamala's practices do not ask you to acquire anything. It asks you to look closely enough at your existing relationship with wealth, desire, and exchange to see what is habit, what is inherited fear, and what is actually true.

The seven practices below move from recognizing what you already have, through the fears that distort it, and into the practice of giving and receiving cleanly. Work through them in order. The lotus stays rooted in mud and still opens; this material asks the same of you while you continue handling money, pleasure, and comfort exactly as before.

Practice One – Recognizing Wealth Beyond Money

Practice. Complete the sentence “a wealthy person is...” ten times and notice which themes keep repeating. Through the day, ask what forms of wealth are already present that money cannot buy: health, friendship, silence, clean water, trust, knowledge, beauty, freedom, time. Ask which of these you already have, which you have ignored, and which you consistently undervalue.

Evening reflection. What did I already have this morning that I only noticed by evening?

Practice Two – Scarcity Fear

Practice. Whenever anxiety comes up around money, food, time, attention, or relationships, ask what you are afraid will not be enough. Then ask whether the fear is happening now, in this actual moment, or whether it is an inherited habit running on autopilot. Sit with it directly: if I were abundant, what would I have that I do not now? Would having it actually fill anything not already present in me?

Evening reflection. Which of today's scarcity fears were about the present, and which were rehearsing the past?

Practice Three – Examining Desire

Practice. Every time a desire appears today, no matter how small, write it down. Classify it: need, comfort, pleasure, vanity, fear, or genuine calling. Notice how few desires actually come from real need, and notice how convincing the others feel in the moment.

Evening reflection. Of everything I wanted today, what would I still want if no one ever knew I had it?

Practice Four – The Ethics of Exchange

Practice. Review your financial exchanges today, or recent ones, and ask of each: was this honest, was this generous, was this exploitative, was this fearful, was this in alignment. Sit afterward with the wider question of how wealth should move through a good person, treating it as something you can actually practice tomorrow rather than an abstract ideal.

Evening reflection. Where did fear, rather than clarity, decide how I handled money or value today?

Practice Five – Giving

Practice. Give something today that is not only money: attention, encouragement, food, time, knowledge, forgiveness, labour. Notice what happens internally as you give. If resistance shows up, ask directly what you are resisting and why you are contracting around it.

Evening reflection. What did I almost withhold today, and what was underneath the impulse to withhold it?

Practice Six – Receiving

Practice. Practice receiving well: compliments, help, kindness, food, opportunities, affection, without deflecting, apologizing, feeling you need to earn it, or minimizing it. Notice why receiving is harder than giving, and notice exactly where in your body the discomfort shows up.

Evening reflection. What did I deflect today that I could have simply let land?

Practice Seven – What Is Freely Given

Practice. Contemplate everything that arrives without payment: sunlight, breath, rain, birdsong, gravity, intelligence, consciousness, love, the possibility of waking up at all. If all of this is already freely given, ask what true wealth actually means, and how you might participate in this abundance rather than simply consuming it.

Evening reflection. Having sat with all seven practices, what do I now call wealth that I would not have called wealth before?

Advanced Exercises

The Unearned Gift. Give something significant to someone who has no way to repay you and no way to know it came from you. Notice every impulse to be recognized for it, and let the impulse pass without acting on it.

The Empty Hands Day. Spend one day handling money only for genuine necessities, and notice every place a small unnecessary purchase would ordinarily have filled a moment of boredom, anxiety, or emptiness.

The Compliment Held. The next time you receive real praise, resist the urge to immediately deflect, joke, or return a compliment. Simply say thank you, and stay in the discomfort of being fully seen and valued.

The Deeper Principle

Kamala arrives after nine Mahavidyas that strip a practitioner of exactly what she appears, at first glance, to represent: wealth, beauty, pleasure, comfort. This is not a contradiction in the sequence. It is the entire point of placing her last.

A person who has not been through death, fear, sacrifice, loss, invisibility, and the interruption of momentum tends to hold money and beauty as the whole of what matters, gripped tightly, defended anxiously, chased without end. A person who arrives at Kamala after that work holds the very same things differently. Nothing on the outside needs to change. What changes is the grip.

This is why the lotus stays the central image throughout her worship. It does not rise above the mud, and it does not pretend the mud is not there. It simply grows out of it, fully rooted, while the flower itself carries none of what it grew from. That is the entire teaching of her practices: full engagement with money, pleasure, and exchange, held by someone no longer secretly run by fear of scarcity.

Her Faculty

If each Mahavidya develops one irreplaceable human capacity, Kamala's is the capacity to hold abundance cleanly. Call it rooted generosity: the ability to give and receive value, in any form, without contraction, without needing to earn it first, and without secretly bracing for its loss.

This is a rarer capacity than it sounds. Most people can perform generosity or perform gratitude. Far fewer can actually receive well, or give without an unconscious ledger running underneath. Kamala's practices train exactly that muscle, and it is, appropriately, the last one this path asks a student to develop.